Final Project: Animated Mobile Weather App Promo

Objective

Create a short (40-60 second) animated video that simulates a mobile weather app interface.

Your video will include smooth transitions, logo reveals, animated weather icons, message pop-ups, and a green screen composite.

By completing this project, you'll practice key skills like keyframing, masking, easing, motion blur, and compositing.

Step-by-Step Process

1. Project Setup

Open Adobe After Effects and create a new project.

Composition settings:

- Name: Weather App Promo
- Resolution: 1920x1080 (HD)
- Duration: 1 minute
- Frame Rate: 30fps

Save as Final_WeatherApp_Promo.aep.

2. Create Intro Transition

Import a short clip or background image.

Add a shape layer (rectangle or circle) that slides in as a transition.

Animate its position using keyframes.

Enable Motion Blur and apply Easy Ease for smoothness.

3. Logo Reveal

Import or create a simple logo.

Mask it using the Rectangle Tool to hide it fully.

Animate the Mask Path to reveal it.

Add rotation or scale for extra flair.

Optional: Add glow or light sweep effects.

4. Message Pop-Up

Create a Shape Layer (speech bubble or rectangle).

Add text inside it (e.g., 'Welcome to the Weather App').

Animate both shape and text with Position and Opacity.

Use Easy Ease and Motion Blur for a soft motion.

5. Weather Scene Animation

Inside the mobile screen, create 4 phases: Morning, Day, Evening, Night.

Add backgrounds and weather icons for each.

Animate Position and Opacity for smooth transitions.

Use Easy Ease for natural motion.

6. Add Green Screen Composite

Import a green screen video.

Apply Effect > Keying > Keylight (1.2).

Use the Screen Color picker to remove green.

Adjust Clip Black/White and Despill Bias for clean edges.

Place the mobile app background behind the subject.

7. Finishing Touches

Enable Motion Blur on all moving layers.

Sync transitions to background music.

Add soft shadows or reflections.

Adjust keyframe timing for smoothness.

Add final text like 'Download Now!' or 'Check Weather Anywhere!'.

8. Render and Export

Go to Composition > Add to Render Queue.

Set format to H.264 (MP4).

Resolution: 1920x1080 (HD).

Choose output folder and click Render.

Final Deliverables

- A 40-60 second MP4 video showing:
  - Scene transitions
  - Logo reveal
  - Text/message animation
  - Weather scene animation
  - Green screen composite

- The corresponding After Effects project file (.aep)

Tips for Success

- Use Easy Ease on all keyframes for smoother motion.
- Preview your animation often to adjust timing.
- Save your project frequently.
- Keep your timeline clean and organized.
- Use color-coding for layers to stay organized.

What You Will Learn

By completing this integrated project, you will learn:

- Mask-based logo and text reveals
- Smooth transitions and easing
- Animating shapes, text, and icons
- Compositing green screen footage
- Building a professional, cohesive motion design video